

Documents for Pre-Approval

Lenders use these documents to verify your income, assets, debts, and identity. You may not need every item listed below, but having them ready can help the process move faster.

Personal Information

- ☐ Government-issued photo ID (driver's license or passport)
- ☐ Social Security Number or ITIN
- ☐ Proof of legal residency or work authorization, *if applicable*

Income Verification

- ☐ Recent pay stubs (usually the last 2 months')
- ☐ W-2 forms from the last 2 years
- ☐ Federal tax returns from the last 2 years (*especially if self-employed or if income varies*)
- ☐ Proof of additional income, if applicable (for example, overtime, bonuses, child support, alimony, Social Security, pensions)

Employment History

- ☐ Contact information for your employer(s)
- ☐ Employment history for the last 2 years
- ☐ If self-employed: year-to-date profit and loss statement and business tax returns

Assets and Savings

- ☐ Bank statements from the last 2–3 months (*checking and savings*)
- ☐ Statements for retirement accounts, investments, or other assets
- ☐ Documentation for gift funds, if someone is helping with your down payment

Debts and Monthly Obligations

- ☐ Information about student loans, car loans, credit cards, and other debts
- ☐ Documentation for child support or alimony payments, *if applicable*

Credit and Authorization

- ☐ Provide the lender with permission to pull your credit report
- ☐ Explanation letters, *if requested*, for things like past credit issues, gaps in employment, or recent large deposits

Helpful Tip!

Try not to open new credit accounts or make large purchases while you're getting pre-approved or before buying a home — these can affect your loan eligibility.